experiments that involved bio-medicine, material processing, and remote sensing. In all, Sharma and his Soviet colleagues spent 7 days, 21 hours, and 40 minutes aboard the Salyut 7. This mission made India the 14th nation to send a human into space.

By 1993, India had launched 16 satellites from at least 5 different countries, helping to develop the digital technology of the entire globe. India's communications and space flight specialists continued to launch satellites, building upon their existing knowledge to the point that in 2008, their own lunar orbiter, Chandryaan, was set in place around the moon. Chandrayaan functioned for almost a year and launched its own Moon Impact Probe.

During Chandryaan's 312 days in service, it mapped the chemical characteristics of the moon's surface, using 3D topography. Five Indian-made instruments aided the research, plus six from other participating countries. The points of interest on the lunar surface were its polar regions, as it was hoped that these areas might be hiding water in the form of ice. Indeed, it surveyed the lunar surface to produce a complete map of its chemical characteristics and a 3-dimensional topography chart. Indeed, Chandrayaan became the first lunar mission to find proof of the existence of ice on the moon.

To celebrate the massive achievement of the Indian-led project, the Chandrayaan team received multiple international awards, including the SPACE 2009 Award from the American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics, the International Cooperation Award from the International Lunar Exploration Working Group, and the Space Pioneer Award from the National Space Society. The existence of ice on the moon was sensational news for those involved in space exploration because water—in any form—is considered the most important ingredient in the development and evolution of life.

The scientific community went crazy for ISRO's lunar data, but India's space program was far from finished. Another trained Indian astronaut, a woman named Kalpana Chawla, was chosen as part of the six-person crew of the Space Shuttle *Columbia* flight STS-87. The *Columbia* launched on November 19th, 1997, with Chawla on board, in charge of deploying the Spartan satellite.

In 2000, Chawla was selected again to join a new crew for a mission aboard the same space shuttle, but the trip was postponed until 2003. Chawla